PORTLAND PUBLIC SCHOOLS
Board of Education
Thursday, April 3, 2025

Policy Committee Meeting

Informal Meeting Minutes

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Pursuant to notice made by posting to the Board's public notices webpage and emailed to persons on the mailing list, a Policy Committee Meeting of the Portland Public Schools Board of Education was held at Dr. Matthew Prophet Education Center - Board Auditorium, 501 N. Dixon St, Portland, OR 97227 and streamed live at: https://www.youtube.com/@ppsboardofeducation/live

Attendance

Director Julia Brim-Edwards: Present, Director Michelle DePass: Present, Director Patte Sullivan: Present.

Other Attendees
Liz Large – Contracted Senior Legal Advisor
Dr. Emily Glasgow – Senior Director, PK-5 Core Academics
Dana Stiles – Director, Head Start
Judy Brennan – Director, Enrollment Planning

Call to Order / Introductions

The Meeting was called to order by Committee Chair Julia Brim-Edwards at 4:23 pm. She highlighted the agenda and announced a change in its sequence.

Public Comment

Public Comment was offered during the related agenda topic.

Policies in the Public Comment Period - Policy Revisions: 1.20.010-P Board of Education and 5.10.066-P Ethics and Conflict of Interest Policy

Time: 4:26 pm

Chair Brim-Edwards noted that the Board of Education Policy 1.20.010-P and Ethics and Conflict of Interest Policy 5.10.066-P received a first reading at the March 18, 2025 Board Meeting. She shared that additional language has been proposed for Policy 5.10.066-P and provided a summary of the proposed amendment, which would allow an exemption for board members wishing to enter the hiring process during the last six months of their term for the following year, and read the new language aloud. The Committee discussed the proposed amendment. The policy was unanimously referred for a second first reading.

Draft Proposed New Policy x.xx.xxx-P Solicitation Registration and Reporting

Time: 4:34 pm

Committee Chair Brim-Edwards introduced the draft of a new policy for consideration related to transparency in district interactions, adding that the draft policy is not yet ready for action.

It was noted that the Director of Purchasing and Contracting sent some information to Committee members regarding the district procurement processes. Discussion topics included contract types that do not prompt a Request for Proposal (RFP) process, potential influence in non-competitive contracting, the proposed registration process and what type of entities would be required to register under the proposed policy. There was emphasis on keeping the system simple and focused on transparency, not restricting engagement.

Committee Chair Brim-Edwards requested that committee members compile their questions and send them to her directly before the next meeting.

4.10.020-P Compulsory Enrollment: Age and Grade Level at

Time: 4:57 pm

Staff: Dr. Emily Glasgow, Dana Stiles, Judy Brennan

Committee Chair Brim-Edwards introduced the policy, confirming that no action on the policy would be taken at this time. It was noted that the Early Learners department provided written responses to

previously submitted questions at the start of the meeting. There was discussion on the proposed revisions.

The discussion focused on the implications of maintaining or revising the September 1 kindergarten entry cutoff date. Members acknowledged that while a strict cutoff is the most equitable, no date serves all families equally, and school readiness varies widely. Concerns were raised about the reliability of assessing readiness, with data showing readiness assessments are accurate only about half the time. The committee also discussed how many current first-grade students would have been affected by a more flexible entry date, specifically those with September birthdays. Additionally, there was discussion about whether to revise the policy that currently allows students who completed kindergarten at accredited institutions to transfer into Portland Public Schools, with maintaining consistency noted as a reason to retain that option.

The Committee heard public comment on the policy.

- Jessica Colby, TAGAC: In support of a later kindergarten entry cutoff date to provide flexibility for families and better meet individual student readiness.

Adjourn

The meeting was adjourned at 5:36 pm.

Submitted by:

Kara Bradshaw
Executive Assistant/Board Clerk
Portland Public Schools